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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/MGU-BBA (Honours)/MGU-BCA (Honours) Regular Examination, October 2026

FIFTH SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG5DSEHISA01 - NATIONALISM AND NATION-BUILDING IN POSTCOLONIAL CONTEXTS

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

ANSWER KEY

Part A
ANSWER IN ONE OR TWO SENTENCES
Answer any 10 questions
Each question carries 2 marks

1) Primordialists (Edward Shils, 1957; Clifford Geertz, 1963) treat national attachments as natural, ancient and fixed 'givens' of blood, language, religion and territory- main criticism: the view cannot explain why nations emerge only at particular historical moments, or why identities change, merge or disappear- modernists (Gellner, Hobsbawm, Anderson) show nations to be recent products of industrialisation, print and the modern state- Eller and Coughlan (1993) call primordial ties asserted rather than explained- ignores the 'invention of tradition' (Hobsbawm and Ranger, 1983) and elite manipulation of identity (Paul Brass's instrumentalism). [Any one criticism]

2) Shared experience of colonial domination created a common enemy and common grievances- economic exploitation (Dadabhai Naoroji's 'drain of wealth')- racial discrimination and exclusion of the colonised from higher administration- Western education, print, railways and a unified colonial administration produced a connected middle class familiar with ideas of liberty and self-determination- cultural assertion in the 'inner domain' (Partha Chatterjee). [Any one reason]

3) Sukarno and Hatta proclaimed independence on 17 August 1945, two days after Japan's surrender- the Netherlands refused to recognise the Republic and returned behind Allied (British) forces to restore colonial rule- led to the Indonesian National Revolution (1945-49): Battle of Surabaya (October-December 1945), the Linggadjati (1946-47) and Renville (1948) agreements, and two Dutch 'police actions' (1947, 1948)- UN and US pressure produced the Round Table Conference at The Hague and the transfer of sovereignty on 27 December 1949.

4) Sarojini Naidu leading the Dharasana salt satyagraha (May 1930)- Aruna Asaf Ali hoisting the Congress flag at Gowalia Tank, Bombay, on 9 August 1942- Usha Mehta's underground Congress Radio (August 1942)- Lakshmi Swaminathan (Sahgal) commanding the Rani of Jhansi Regiment of the INA (1943)- Akkamma Cherian leading the Travancore State Congress rally (1938)- women couriers and fighters in Kenya's Mau Mau and Algeria's FLN (Djamila Bouhired). [Any one example]

5) The Federal Military Government's land, sea and air blockade of Biafra (1967-70) cut off food and medical supplies- mass starvation and kwashiorkor, especially among children- starvation used as a weapon of war ('all is fair in war, and starvation is one of the weapons of war')- estimates of deaths range from about 500,000 to 3 million (1 to 2 million most often cited), mostly civilians dying of famine- relief reached only through a clandestine church airlift to the Uli airstrip.

6) Colonial rulers deliberately fostered and institutionalised differences of religion, caste, ethnicity or region among the colonised (*divide et impera*) to prevent united resistance- in India: Partition of Bengal (1905), separate electorates for Muslims under the Morley-Minto Reforms (1909), the Communal Award (1932) and 'martial races' recruitment- in Rwanda the Belgians favoured the Tutsi and introduced ethnic identity cards (1933)- indirect rule kept Northern and Southern Nigeria apart- these categories later hardened into postcolonial conflict.

7) Remote and border regions with rough terrain and thin administrative, police and infrastructural presence offer insurgents safe havens, supply routes and recruits- porous borders allow cross-border sanctuary, arms and drug trafficking- neglect and lack of services breed alienation, letting insurgents act as a parallel government- Fearon and Laitin (2003): weak state capacity and rough terrain, rather than ethnic diversity alone, predict insurgency- e.g., India's Northeast, the 'Red Corridor', the Sahel, Myanmar's borderlands, the Afghanistan-Pakistan frontier.

8) A renewed form of nationalism, prominent since the end of the Cold War and especially after the 2008 financial crisis- defensive and exclusionary, stressing cultural homogeneity, sovereignty and border control against globalisation, immigration and supranational bodies- often linked to right-wing populism and majoritarianism- e.g., Brexit (2016), 'America First', anti-immigrant parties in Europe- Eger and Valdez (2015)- the term was earlier used by Tom Nairn, *The Break-up of Britain: Crisis and Neo-Nationalism* (1977).

9) The Facebook page 'We Are All Khaled Said' (administered by Wael Ghonim) called the 25 January 2011 protests at Tahrir Square, Cairo, during the Arab Spring, which forced Hosni Mubarak's resignation- other valid examples: #EndSARS in Nigeria (2020), Hong Kong protests via Telegram (2019), Sri Lanka's Aragalaya (2022), Bangladesh's student quota movement (2024), Nepal's 'Gen Z' protests (September 2025). [Any one example]

10) Institutions (constitution, independent judiciary, election commission, professional bureaucracy, rule of law) give a new state legitimacy, stability and continuity beyond individual leaders- channel conflict through peaceful, rule-bound means- protect rights and minorities- deliver services and development, building citizens' trust- Acemoglu and Robinson, *Why Nations Fail* (2012): inclusive institutions sustain prosperity, extractive ones produce decay- e.g., India's constitutional democracy and Botswana, contrasted with recurrent military coups in Pakistan.

11) Citizenship is the legal status of full membership of a political community (the state), carrying rights and duties- T. H. Marshall, *Citizenship and Social Class* (1950): civil, political and social rights- acquired by birth (*jus soli*), descent (*jus sanguinis*), registration or naturalisation- also implies participation and a sense of belonging- in India governed by Part II (Articles 5-11) of the Constitution and the Citizenship Act, 1955.

12) Greater collective bargaining power in global forums- expansion of trade and markets (e.g., AfCFTA, SAFTA)- peaceful settlement of disputes and regional security- shared infrastructure, connectivity, disaster management and resource sharing- e.g., ASEAN (Bangkok Declaration, 1967) promoting peace and economic integration in Southeast Asia; also the African Union, SAARC, BIMSTEC. [Any one benefit]

Part B
SHORT ANSWER
Answer any 6 questions
Each question carries 5 marks

13) Amílcar Cabral (1924-73), founder-leader of the PAIGC (1956), led the liberation struggle of Guinea-Bissau and Cape Verde against Portugal- 'National Liberation and Culture' (Eduardo Mondlane Memorial Lecture, Syracuse University, 1970): imperialism seeks to destroy the culture of the dominated, because culture is the expression of a people's history- hence 'national liberation is necessarily an act of culture'- culture survived among the rural masses as the basis of resistance- the assimilated petty bourgeoisie must 're-Africanise' and identify with the masses, 'committing suicide as a class' ('The Weapon of Theory', Havana, 1966)- the idea of a 'return to the source' (*Return to the Source*, 1973)- culture to be critically renewed, not romanticised: retain positive elements, discard negative ones (tribalism, superstition)- in liberated zones the PAIGC built schools, health posts and people's stores, making culture a weapon of struggle- assassinated in Conakry on 20 January 1973; independence declared on 24 September 1973.

14) Early phase: women in Swadeshi boycotts (1905)- Bhikaiji Cama unfurled an Indian flag at the International Socialist Congress, Stuttgart (1907)- Annie Besant's Home Rule League (1916) and Congress presidency (1917)- Gandhian mass phase drew women into picketing liquor and foreign-cloth shops, spinning and khadi- Civil Disobedience: Sarojini Naidu (first Indian woman Congress President, 1925) at Dharasana; Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay; thousands courting arrest- revolutionary nationalism: Pritilata Waddedar (Pahartali raid, 1932), Bina Das, Kalpana Datta- Quit India: Aruna Asaf Ali, Usha Mehta, Sucheta Kripalani, Matangini Hazra (shot at Tamluk, 1942)- Kasturba Gandhi died in detention (1944)- INA's Rani of Jhansi Regiment under Lakshmi Sahgal- Kerala: Akkamma Cherian (1938)- fifteen women in the Constituent Assembly- limits: nationalism often subordinated the 'women's question' (Partha Chatterjee; Geraldine Forbes, *Women in Modern India*).

15) The nation is commonly imagined as a mother or goddess to be loved, served and protected- Bharat Mata: Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay's 'Vande Mataram' in *Anandamath* (1882); Abanindranath Tagore's *Bharat Mata* (1905) painted during the Swadeshi movement; cartographic images fusing goddess and map (Sumathi Ramaswamy, *The Goddess and the Nation*, 2010); Bharat Mata Mandir, Varanasi (1936)- elsewhere: Marianne (France), Britannia, Mother Russia, Mother Ireland- Nira Yuval-Davis, *Gender and Nation* (1997): women as biological and cultural reproducers and symbolic 'border guards' of the nation- national honour located in women's bodies, hence sexual violence against women in conflicts (Partition, 1947)- Anne McClintock: 'all nationalisms are gendered'; women serve as symbols while denied direct political agency- such imagery may also carry a religious idiom that excludes minorities.

16) Before: UNAMIR (Resolution 872, October 1993) under General Roméo Dallaire- Dallaire's 'genocide fax' (11 January 1994) warning of planned killings went unheeded- During (7 April to mid-July 1994; about 800,000 Tutsi and moderate Hutu killed, estimates ranging from about 500,000 to over a million): foreign nationals evacuated- after ten Belgian peacekeepers were killed, Belgium withdrew- Resolution 912 (21 April) cut UNAMIR to 270- the US, shadowed by Somalia (1993), avoided the word 'genocide'- Resolution 918 (17 May) imposed an arms embargo, but troops arrived late- France's Opération Turquoise (Resolution 929, June 1994) was criticised for letting perpetrators escape to Zaire- After: RPF victory (July 1994)- ICTR at Arusha (Resolution 955, November 1994); Akayesu judgment (1998) held that rape can constitute genocide- refugee crisis in Goma and the Congo wars- Clinton's apology (1998), Kofi Annan's 'deep remorse' (1999, Carlsson inquiry), Macron's acknowledgement of responsibility (2021)- gacaca courts- stimulus to the Responsibility to Protect doctrine (2001, 2005).

17) Convened by Bismarck in Berlin (November 1884 to February 1885); fourteen states attended, no African was represented- General Act of Berlin (1885): principle of effective occupation and notification of claims- Leopold II's claim over the Congo recognised; free trade in the Congo basin and free navigation of the Congo and Niger- accelerated the Scramble for Africa- the conference set rules; most frontiers were then fixed by bilateral treaties on European maps, using rivers, lines of latitude and longitude and other straight lines- boundaries ignored ethnic, linguistic, ecological and political realities- divided peoples: the Somali (among British, Italian and French Somaliland, Ethiopia and Kenya), the Ewe (Gold Coast and Togoland), the Maasai (Kenya and Tanganyika), the Bakongo- grouped rival societies into single colonies (Nigeria, Sudan)- the OAU (Cairo, 1964) accepted colonial borders, leaving a legacy of border wars (Ogaden), secessionism (Biafra, Katanga) and irredentism.

18) Colonial economic structure: dependence on export of primary commodities, monoculture, weak industrial base- uneven regional development (coast versus interior, East versus West Pakistan leading to the Six-Point Programme and 1971)- control of natural resources and the 'resource curse' (Niger Delta oil)- economic inequality between ethnic groups (Malaysia's 1969 riots and New Economic Policy, 1971; expulsion of Asians from Uganda, 1972)- unresolved land question (Kenya; Zimbabwe's fast-track land reform, 2000)- 1980s debt crisis and IMF-World Bank Structural Adjustment Programmes cutting subsidies and public spending- neo-colonialism (Kwame Nkrumah, 1965) and dependency (Andre Gunder Frank; Walter Rodney, *How Europe Underdeveloped Africa*, 1972)- unemployment, rural-urban divide and 'sons of the soil' movements- debate between state-led planning and market liberalisation (India, 1991).

19) Agreement signed at the Sixth BRICS Summit, Fortaleza (July 2014); operational from 2015 with headquarters in Shanghai- authorised capital US$100 billion; initial subscribed capital US$50 billion shared equally by Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa- equal voting, no veto- aims: mobilise resources for infrastructure and sustainable development in BRICS and other emerging and developing economies; complement and offer an alternative to Western-dominated Bretton Woods institutions; promote lending in local currencies- presidents: K. V. Kamath (India), Marcos Troyjo (Brazil), Dilma Rousseff (since 2023, re-elected 2025)- achievements: about 139 projects and roughly US$43 billion approved by mid-2026 (transport, water, clean energy, urban development); green bonds in China's market (from 2016); COVID-19 emergency lending (up to US$10 billion); membership extended to Bangladesh, the UAE, Egypt, Algeria and Uzbekistan- limitations: small scale relative to the World Bank, continuing

dollar dependence (local-currency lending about 30 per cent), freezing of new Russian projects after 2022 sanctions.

20) Social media allows rapid, low-cost, decentralised and often leaderless mobilisation through hashtags, groups and encrypted messaging- bypasses state-controlled and mainstream media- enables diaspora participation ('long-distance nationalism')- spreads national symbols through memes, images and videos- examples: Arab Spring (2011), #EndSARS (2020), Sri Lanka's Aragalaya (2022), Nepal's 'Gen Z' protests (2025)- Zeynep Tufekci, *Twitter and Tear Gas* (2017): networked movements mobilise quickly but are weak in organisation and negotiation; Manuel Castells, *Networks of Outrage and Hope* (2012)- darker side: majoritarian 'digital nationalism', organised troll networks, misinformation, hate speech and echo chambers- states respond with surveillance, censorship and internet shutdowns.

21) Linguistic diversity: a 'neutral' link language avoided the dominance of one group (Nigeria with over 500 languages; India's Article 343 retained English alongside Hindi; anti-Hindi agitation in Tamil Nadu, 1965; Official Languages Act, 1963)- administration, law, courts and higher education already functioned in that language- the nationalist elite was educated in it- access to science, technology, global trade and diplomacy- national unity and cost of transition- e.g., French in Senegal and Côte d'Ivoire, English in Ghana, Kenya (with Kiswahili) and the Philippines- Rwanda's switch from French to English (2008) shows strategic choice- critique: Ngũgĩ wa Thiong'o, *Decolonising the Mind* (1986): language carries culture, so its retention prolongs mental colonisation and elitism; Chinua Achebe defended adapting English- contrasts: Kiswahili in Tanzania; Sri Lanka's Sinhala Only Act (1956) fuelled ethnic conflict.

22) Rules of *jus soli* (birth) imply a civic, territorial idea of the nation; *jus sanguinis* (descent) implies an ethnic idea (Rogers Brubaker, 1992, on France and Germany)- India: the Constitution adopted an inclusive, civic *jus soli* model; amendments of 1986 (one parent to be Indian) and 2003 (neither parent an illegal migrant) moved towards descent (Niraja Gopal Jayal, *Citizenship and Its Discontents*, 2013)- Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019 (Rules, March 2024): faster citizenship for Hindu, Sikh, Buddhist, Jain, Parsi and Christian migrants from Afghanistan, Bangladesh and Pakistan who entered before 31 December 2014, criticised for excluding Muslims- Assam NRC (2019) left about 19 lakh people out- Myanmar's Citizenship Law (1982) rendered the Rohingya stateless- Ceylon Citizenship Act (1948) left Indian Tamil plantation workers stateless- citizenship law thus defines who belongs to the nation and who is excluded.

Part C
SHORT ESSAY
Answer any 2 questions
Each question carries 10 marks

23) Benedict Anderson, *Imagined Communities* (1983; revised 1991): the nation is 'an imagined political community, and imagined as both inherently limited and sovereign'- imagined because members never meet most of their fellows, yet hold an image of their communion- a 'deep, horizontal comradeship'- preconditions: decline of sacred script-languages (Latin), dynastic realms and cosmological time, replaced by 'homogeneous, empty time' (Walter Benjamin)- print-capitalism: books as early mass commodities; vernacular print-languages created unified fields of exchange, fixed languages and produced 'languages of power'- the novel and the newspaper represent simultaneity,

readers imagining others reading the same news; the newspaper as a 'one-day best-seller' and its reading as a 'mass ceremony' (Hegel's morning prayer)- Creole pioneers and colonial nationalism: bilingual intelligentsia, schools and administrative 'pilgrimages'; census, map and museum shaped the colonial state's imagination (1991 edition)- India: Hicky's *Bengal Gazette* (1780); *Amrita Bazar Patrika* (1868); Tilak's *Kesari* and *Mahratta* (1881); Vernacular Press Act (1878); novels such as *Anandamath*; Kerala's *Swadeshabhimani*, whose editor K. Ramakrishna Pillai was banished (1910)- later radio, cinema and social media- critique: Partha Chatterjee ('Whose imagined community?', *The Nation and Its Fragments*, 1993): if colonial nationalisms only borrowed modular European forms, 'what do they have left to imagine?'; anticolonial nationalism first claimed sovereignty in the spiritual 'inner domain'- low literacy meant oral, performative and religious media mattered too- neglect of gender and religion- conclusion: Anderson explains how media make the nation thinkable, though not every form of national feeling.

24) Artificial borders: Berlin Conference (1884-85), Durand Line (1893), Radcliffe Line (1947) left divided peoples, irredentism and secession (Biafra, Katanga, Eritrea, Kashmir)- colonial classification and census turned fluid identities into rigid categories: Mahmood Mamdani, *Citizen and Subject* (1996) on 'decentralised despotism' and *When Victims Become Killers* (2001) on Rwanda's racialised Hutu-Tutsi divide- divide and rule and uneven favour: separate electorates and Partition in India; British reliance on English-educated Tamils in Ceylon followed by the Sinhala Only Act (1956), Black July (1983) and civil war till 2009- separate administration: Sudan's Southern Policy (1930), two civil wars and South Sudan's independence (2011); India's Northeast under the Inner Line and excluded areas- distorted economies and resource enclaves: Niger Delta oil- authoritarian colonial state apparatus inherited: sedition laws, emergency powers, AFSPA (1958) modelled on a 1942 ordinance- settler land alienation: Kenya, Zimbabwe- critical evaluation: colonialism is not the sole cause; postcolonial elites' majoritarian nation-building, centralisation, corruption, Cold War interventions and economic failure also matter (Basil Davidson, *The Black Man's Burden*, 1992, on the 'curse of the nation-state')- conclusion: colonial legacies created the structures of conflict, while postcolonial choices often activated them.

25) Model answer: the Rohingya crisis- background: Rohingya Muslims of Rakhine (Arakan) state; colonial-era labour migration from Chittagong and communal violence during the Second World War (1942) shaped later suspicion- Burmese Buddhist nationalism portrays them as illegal 'Bengalis'- causes: Burma Citizenship Law (1982) excluded them from recognised 'national races', making most stateless; restrictions on movement, marriage, education; violence of 2012; anti-Muslim campaigns (969 movement, Ma Ba Tha) and hate speech on Facebook; ARSA attacks (25 August 2017) followed by military 'clearance operations' with mass killing, rape and burning of villages- consequences: over 700,000 fled to Bangladesh in 2017; today over one million live in 33 camps at Cox's Bazar (Kutupalong) and on Bhasan Char- strain on Bangladesh: environment, host-community tensions, security, aid cuts- secondary flight by sea and to India, Malaysia and Indonesia- legal action: The Gambia v. Myanmar at the ICJ (2019; provisional measures, January 2020), ICC investigation (2019) and the Prosecutor's warrant request against Senior General Min Aung Hlaing (2024)- the 2021 coup and renewed fighting in Rakhine have blocked safe return- illustrates how exclusionary, ethno-religious nation-building produces statelessness and mass displacement. [Answers on any other major crisis, such as Partition (1947), Bangladesh (1971), the Syrian refugee crisis (since 2011) or Sudan (since 2023), may be valued on the same lines of causes and consequences.]

26) During the Cold War, postcolonial diplomacy centred on Non-Alignment (Bandung, 1955; Belgrade, 1961) and Third World solidarity (G77, NIEO)- end of bipolarity (1991) reduced NAM's relevance- shift from ideological to pragmatic and economic diplomacy: liberalisation (India, 1991), WTO (1995), trade agreements- India: Look East (1991-92) to Act East (2014); full relations with Israel (1992); Pokhran-II (1998); Indo-US civil nuclear agreement (2005-08); 'strategic autonomy' and 'multi-alignment': Quad (revived 2017) alongside SCO (2017) and BRICS- new South-South coalitions: IBSA (2003), BRICS (2009; expanded from 2024), G20 summits (2008), New Development Bank- China's rise and the Belt and Road Initiative (2013); African states balancing China, the West, Russia, Turkey and the Gulf- regionalism: African Union (2002), AfCFTA, ASEAN- new agendas: terrorism after 9/11, climate diplomacy (common but differentiated responsibilities; Paris, 2015; loss and damage fund, 2022), health and vaccine diplomacy, diaspora and soft power- the 'Global South' voice: India's G20 presidency (2023) admitting the African Union as a permanent member; Voice of the Global South Summits; India's BRICS chairship (New Delhi summit, 2026)- abstentions on the 2022 Ukraine resolution show hedging- continuing limits: demands for UN Security Council reform, asymmetries of power- conclusion: from collective non-alignment to multi-aligned, interest-based diplomacy in a multipolar world.